

■ MissingCash

THE COMPLETE AUSTRALIAN UNCLAIMED CASH GUIDE

Your step-by-step premium guide to finding and claiming every dollar of unclaimed cash, lost superannuation, rental bonds, tax refunds and more across Australia.

\$2.6B+ Unclaimed Cash	\$16B+ Lost Super	8 States All Covered
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How Unclaimed Money Works in Australia

Every year, billions of dollars sit unclaimed in Australia. This happens because people move house, change names, forget old accounts, or simply don't know they're owed money. Australian law requires organisations to hand this money to government authorities after a set period of inactivity — where it waits for the rightful owner to claim it.

Where Does Unclaimed Money Come From?

Bank accounts	Inactive for 7+ years — transferred to ASIC
Shares & dividends	Uncashed dividends or shares in inactive accounts
Life insurance	Unclaimed policies or matured investments
Superannuation	Inactive accounts transferred to the ATO after 2 years
Rental bonds	Unclaimed bonds held by state bond authorities
Tax refunds	Overpaid tax the ATO couldn't return to you
Wages	Unpaid wages held by the Fair Work Ombudsman
Estates	Money from deceased estates not yet claimed

■ *Tip: Search under every name you've ever used — maiden name, hyphenated names, nicknames. Records are filed under the name used at the time.*

The 7-Year Rule

For bank accounts, shares and insurance, money becomes 'unclaimed' after 7 years of inactivity. The organisation must then transfer it to ASIC, which holds it on your behalf indefinitely. There is no time limit on claiming — money from decades ago is still claimable today.

Interest is paid on unclaimed money calculated from 1 July 2013, so your money grows while it waits.

■ ■ **Some third-party 'money finder' services charge 10–30% of whatever they recover. You NEVER need to pay anyone a percentage — this guide shows you how to claim everything yourself for free.**

ASIC National Unclaimed Money Search

The ASIC Moneysmart register covers bank accounts, shares, life insurance and investments — approximately \$2.6 billion in unclaimed money. Searching is free and takes under 2 minutes.

Step-by-Step Search Guide

1	Go to MoneySmart Open moneysmart.gov.au/find-unclaimed-money in your browser
2	Enter your full name Use your legal name as it appeared on bank accounts. Try variations — maiden name, middle name, initials
3	Review all results Click each result to see the account name, amount and the original institution
4	Note the OTN number Every record has a unique OTN (On-line Transaction Number). Save this — you'll need it to claim
5	Search again with variations Try: maiden name, abbreviated first name, hyphenated surname, old address suburb
6	Check family members Search parents, grandparents, deceased relatives — you may be entitled to claim as executor or beneficiary

How to Make a Claim

Money Source	How to Claim
Bank accounts	Contact the bank directly with your OTN and ID. Visit a branch if the account is old.
Shares & dividends	Lodge a claim directly with ASIC via the Moneysmart portal with your OTN
Life insurance	Contact the insurance company. Provide your OTN and proof of identity or relationship

What ID Will You Need?

- ✓ Australian driver's licence or passport
- ✓ Medicare card
- ✓ Proof of address (utility bill, bank statement)
- ✓ If claiming for a deceased person: death certificate, probate or letters of administration
- ✓ If your name has changed: marriage certificate or change of name certificate

■ *Tip: If you've moved since the original account was opened, you may need to provide an address history. Contact Medicare, AEC (electoral roll) or your roads authority for records.*

Lost Superannuation — Full Claim Guide

Over \$16 billion in lost and unclaimed superannuation sits with the ATO right now. Most people have multiple super accounts from different jobs — each one quietly eating fees while you're not looking.

Why Super Gets Lost

- You changed jobs and forgot to transfer your super
- You changed address and the fund couldn't find you
- The fund became inactive (no contributions for 2+ years)
- You used a different name or TFN at a previous job
- You worked casually or part-time and didn't set up super

How to Find and Claim Lost Super

- 1 Log in to myGov**
Go to my.gov.au and sign in or create a free account
- 2 Link the ATO**
In myGov, click 'Link a service' → select 'Australian Taxation Office'
- 3 Go to Super**
In the ATO section, click 'Super' → 'Manage' → 'Transfer super'
- 4 View all accounts**
The ATO shows every super fund linked to your TFN — including ones you forgot
- 5 Consolidate**
Select old funds and transfer to your active account. No forms — done online instantly
- 6 Check ATO-held super**
Click 'ATO-held super' to claim money the ATO holds directly on your behalf

■ *Tip: You need your Tax File Number (TFN) to access ATO services. If you've lost it, call the ATO on 13 28 65 — they can verify your identity over the phone.*

If You Can't Use myGov

- Call the ATO on 13 28 65 and ask them to search for lost super
- Complete the Searching for lost super (NAT 2476) form from ato.gov.au
- Ask your current super fund — many will search for lost accounts on your behalf

■ **Before consolidating, check if any fund has valuable insurance (life, TPD, income protection) attached. Closing an account cancels the insurance. Ring the fund first to check.**

State-by-State Unclaimed Money

The national ASIC register doesn't cover everything. Each state and territory runs its own register for wages, dividends, cheques, overpayments and more. Most Australians never search these.

NSW	Revenue NSW revenue.nsw.gov.au/unclaimed-money Covers: Wages, salaries, dividends, trust money, cheques, overpayments
VIC	State Revenue Office sro.vic.gov.au/unclaimed-money Covers: Unclaimed money from companies, deceased estates, trust accounts
QLD	QLD Treasury treasury.qld.gov.au → unclaimed monies Covers: Wages, dividends, cheques, overpayments, company money
WA	WA Treasury wa.gov.au → Department of Treasury Covers: Company dividends, salaries, refunds, deposits
SA	SA Treasury treasury.sa.gov.au → unclaimed monies Covers: Company money, wages, dividends, deposits
TAS	TAS Treasury treasury.tas.gov.au/unclaimed-monies Covers: Unclaimed money from companies in Tasmania
NT	NT Territory Revenue treasury.nt.gov.au → unclaimed money Covers: Company and superannuation unclaimed money
ACT	ACT Revenue Office revenue.act.gov.au → unclaimed money Covers: Unclaimed money from ACT-based entities

■ *Tip: Search every state where you've ever lived or worked — not just your current state. Money is registered at the state where the company was based, not where you lived.*

Rental Bond Refunds

Thousands of Australians forget to claim their rental bond after moving — especially if they moved interstate or overseas. Bonds can be hundreds or even thousands of dollars.

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NSW	NSW Fair Trading · fairtrading.nsw.gov.au	1800 422 322
VIC	RTBA · rtba.vic.gov.au	03 9861 8444
QLD	RTA · rta.qld.gov.au	1300 366 311
WA	WA Consumer Protection · commerce.wa.gov.au	1300 304 054
SA	CBS · cbs.sa.gov.au	131 882
TAS	CBOS · cbos.tas.gov.au	1300 654 499

NT	NT Consumer Affairs · consumeraffairs.nt.gov.au	1800 019 319
ACT	ACT Access Canberra · accesscanberra.act.gov.au	13 22 81

■ *Tip: To claim a bond you'll need: your name, previous rental address, approximate tenancy dates, and photo ID. If your landlord disputes the return, the bond authority can help mediate.*

Tax Refunds & ATO Credits

The ATO may owe you money from overpaid tax, unclaimed offsets, or credits that couldn't be processed because your bank details were out of date.

Common Reasons the ATO Owes You Money

PAYG withholding: Your employer withheld too much tax from your pay

Work-related deductions: Deductions you forgot to claim in previous years

Low income tax offset: You earned under the threshold but were taxed

Private health rebate: Unclaimed private health insurance rebates

Government co-contribution: Super contributions the government matched but weren't deposited

Franking credits: Credits from share dividends you didn't claim

How to Check

1

Log in to myGov → ATO

Go to my.gov.au, link ATO if not already done

2

Check 'Income Tax'

Look at your account balance — a negative number means the ATO owes you

3

Lodge overdue returns

You can amend or lodge tax returns up to 2 years back in most cases

4

Update bank details

Make sure your BSB and account number are current so refunds can be paid

■ *Tip: If you have unfiled tax returns from previous years, lodge them. You may find you're owed refunds — and you avoid penalties for late lodgement.*

Wages & Employment Entitlements

The Fair Work Ombudsman holds unpaid wages, leave entitlements and redundancy payments that employers failed to pay.

What You Can Claim

- ✓ Unpaid wages or salary
- ✓ Untaken annual leave paid out on termination
- ✓ Long service leave
- ✓ Redundancy pay
- ✓ Superannuation the employer failed to pay
- ✓ Penalty rates or overtime not paid

How to Check & Claim

- Visit fairwork.gov.au and use the Pay Calculator to check your entitlements
- Lodge an anonymous tip or formal complaint through Fair Work Online
- Call the Fair Work Infoline: 13 13 94
- For unpaid super, report to the ATO at ato.gov.au/unpaysuper

■ ■ There are time limits on wage claims — generally 6 years. Don't delay if you suspect a previous employer owes you money.

Claiming for Deceased Estates

If a family member has passed away, you may be entitled to claim unclaimed money on their behalf as an executor, administrator, or beneficiary.

Who Can Claim

- Executor — named in the will to manage the estate
- Administrator — appointed by the court if there's no will
- Beneficiary — in some cases, with proper documentation
- Next of kin — for small amounts, simpler proof of relationship may suffice

Documents You'll Typically Need

- ✓ Death certificate (certified copy)
- ✓ Probate or Letters of Administration
- ✓ Your own photo ID
- ✓ Proof of relationship (if no probate)
- ✓ The deceased's last known address
- ✓ TFN of the deceased (for super claims)

■ *Tip: Always search under the deceased's full legal name AND any name variations. Women who married may have accounts under their maiden name. Search both.*

10 Common Mistakes to Avoid



Only searching once

Search quarterly — new records are added regularly



Only using your current name

Search maiden names, middle names, hyphenated names and abbreviated first names



Only searching your current state

Search every state where you've ever lived or worked



Ignoring small amounts

A \$57 record is still money you're owed — small amounts add up



Not searching for family members

You can legally claim on behalf of deceased family members with the right documents



Paying someone a percentage

You never need to pay a 'money finder' a percentage — all searches are free



Giving up after one rejection

If rejected, ask for the reason and provide additional documentation



Not updating bank details with ATO

Refunds can't reach you if the ATO has old bank details — update via myGov



Consolidating super without checking insurance

Always call your old fund first to check if insurance is attached



Missing the Fair Work deadline

Wage claims have a 6-year time limit — don't wait

Your Claim Tracker Checklist

Tick each box as you complete it. Most people who complete all steps find at least one unclaimed amount.

✓	Search	Where to go
☐	ASIC MoneySmart Search (National)	moneysmart.gov.au/find-unclaimed-money
☐	ATO Lost Super (via myGov)	my.gov.au → ATO → Super
☐	NSW — Revenue NSW	revenue.nsw.gov.au/unclaimed-money
☐	VIC — State Revenue Office	sro.vic.gov.au/unclaimed-money
☐	QLD — QLD Treasury	treasury.qld.gov.au
☐	WA — WA Treasury	wa.gov.au → Treasury → unclaimed money
☐	SA — SA Treasury	treasury.sa.gov.au/unclaimed-monies
☐	TAS — TAS Treasury	treasury.tas.gov.au/unclaimed-monies
☐	NT — NT Treasury	treasury.nt.gov.au → unclaimed money
☐	ACT — ACT Revenue	revenue.act.gov.au → unclaimed money
☐	NSW Rental Bond	fairtrading.nsw.gov.au
☐	VIC Rental Bond	rtba.vic.gov.au
☐	QLD Rental Bond	rta.qld.gov.au
☐	ATO Tax Refund Check	my.gov.au → ATO → Income Tax
☐	Fair Work — Unpaid Wages	fairwork.gov.au
☐	Searched for deceased family member	All of the above under their name
☐	Searched under maiden/previous names	All of the above with name variations

My Claim Record

Source	Amount	Date Found	Status
	\$	/ /	
	\$	/ /	
	\$	/ /	

	\$		
	\$		
	\$		
	\$		
	\$		

Good luck — go find your cash! ■

Return to missingcash.com.au for the latest links and information.

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